25901922 MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATION,Special examination,July 2026

Third SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG3DSCPSY200 – FOUNDATIONS OF PSYCHOLOGY

Duration: 1 Hour 30 Minutes (2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS) Maximum Marks: 50

Part A Multiple Choice Questions

Answer all questions. Each question carries 1 marks

1. Mixed methods research can overcome [U]**/ [CO1]**

b) Limitations of purely quantitative or qualitative approaches

2 Which somatotype is described as sociable, relaxed, comfort-loving, and round in physique? **(U]/[CO2]**

c) Endomorph

3. Which theory states that emotion follows physiological arousal? [U]/[CO3]

a) James-Lange

4. In experimental research, the factor manipulated is the:**[U]/ [CO1]**

d) Independent variable

5. The survey method mainly relies on: [U]/ [CO1]

a) Questionnaires and interviews

6. Which school of Psychology contributed to understanding depth perception? [K]/ [CO1]

c) Gestalt

7. The component of personality that is a vast reservoir of basic biological urges is the: **[K] / [CO2]**

a) Id.

8. A student who values grades but expects failure will show: [An] / [CO3]

b) Low Motivation

9. Identify the wrong one about illusions from the following statements: [U]/[CO1]

d) Improve social skills

10. Phenomenon where we fail to attend to continuous unchanging stimulus is called [U]/ [CO1]

a) Habituation [1x10 = 10]

Part B

Short Essay Questions.Answer any 2 questions.Each question carries 5 marks

11. Describe how we can experimentally demonstrate any of the phenomenon associated with attention.**. [U]/ [CO1]**

The span of attention is experimentally demonstrated using a **Tachistoscope** to present cards with varying numbers of dots or letters for brief exposures—a duration too short for eye movements or deliberate counting—which consistently reveals that the average human span is limited to 7+- 2 unorganized items. **Division of attention** can be evaluated using a **McDouglas Disc Apparatus** where a participant performs two tasks independently and then simultaneously; a significant drop in accuracy during the simultaneous trial demonstrates that unless a task is automated, division relies on rapid, alternating attention switching rather than true simultaneous processing. Finally, **distraction of attention** is demonstrated by Letter **cancellation Sheet.**

12. What are archetypes according to Jung? Give examples. **[A]/[CO2]**

According to Carl Jung, archetypes are innate, universal, and inherited psychic structures residing within the **collective unconscious**—a layer of the psyche shared by all human beings across time and cultures.

13. State the Yerkes–Dodson law.**. {U]/ [CO3]**

The **Yerkes–Dodson Law** describes an empirical, inverted U-shaped relationship between physiological or mental arousal and performance efficiency. Developed by psychologists Robert Yerkes and John Dillingham Dodson, the law states that performance increases with physiological or cognitive arousal, but only up to an optimal threshold. When arousal levels fall below this optimal point, a person experiences boredom, apathy, or low motivation, leading to suboptimal performance. Conversely, when arousal exceeds the optimal level, extreme anxiety, stress, or sensory overload impairs cognitive capacity and motor execution, causing performance to deteriorate rapidly.

"Level of arousal beyond which performance begin to decline is a function of task difficulty"

[5×2 = 10]

Part C Essay.Answer any 2 questions Each question carries 15 marks

14. Explain in detail the trait theories of personality.. [K]/[CO2]

Gordon Allport pioneered this approach by categorizing traits into **cardinal** (rare, dominant drives), **central** (core building blocks of character), and **secondary** (situational preferences) levels. Moving toward quantitative measurement, Raymond Cattell used factor analysis to distinguish observable **surface traits** from 16 fundamental, underlying **source traits** measured by the 16PF. Hans Eysenck further simplified trait theory into a biologically rooted **PEN model**, focusing on Psychoticism, Extraversion–Introversion, and Neuroticism–Emotional Stability. Today, personality research is dominated by Costa and McCrae's **Five-Factor Model (Big Five/OCEAN)**—Openness, Conscientiousness, Extraversion, Agreeableness, and Neuroticism—providing a universally validated framework for understanding personality stability and individual differences.

15. Explain major physiological and cognitive components of emotion**. [An]/ [CO3]**

Physiologically, an emotional stimulus activates the autonomic nervous system—where the sympathetic division triggers a "fight-or-flight" response (such as increased heart rate and blood pressure) and the parasympathetic division later restores homeostasis—while key neural structures like the amygdala rapidly detect threats, the prefrontal cortex exerts top-down regulation, and the hypothalamus releases stress hormones like adrenaline and cortisol.

Cognitively, an individual interprets and subjectively labels this physiological state; as outlined in Richard Lazarus's Cognitive-Mediational Theory, primary appraisal determines if an event is threatening, challenging, or irrelevant, while secondary appraisal assesses available coping resources. Ultimately, as demonstrated by the Schachter-Singer Two-Factor Theory, physiological arousal provides the intensity of an emotion, but the cognitive evaluation of environmental context assigns its specific qualitative label (e.g., distinguishing excitement on a roller coaster from fear in a dangerous alleyway).

16. Define and explain perceptual constancy and perceptual illusions. Explain the importance of studying constancies and illusions. What are the major types of constancies and illusions?**. [U]/ [CO1]**

Perceptual constancy refers to the remarkable ability of the human visual system to perceive objects as maintaining stable properties—such as size, shape, color, and brightness—despite continuous variations in the physical sensory input reaching the retina. **Perceptual illusions**, on the other hand, occur when there is a mismatch between physical reality and our subjective perception, causing us to misinterpret sensory information.

Perceptual constancies are categorized into three major types: **Size Constancy:** The perception that an object retains its actual physical size regardless of changes in distance or retinal image size (e.g., perceiving an approaching car as moving closer rather than growing larger). **Shape Constancy:** The tendency to perceive a familiar object as maintaining its structural form regardless of shifts in viewing angle (e.g., perceiving a door as rectangular even when it swings open and casts a trapezoidal image on the retina). **Brightness and Color Constancy:** The ability to perceive the intrinsic lightness or color of an object as constant despite variations in ambient illumination (e.g., recognizing a piece of coal as black even under bright sunlight).

Perceptual illusions fall into several primary classifications: **Geometrical-Optical Illusions:** These involve distorted spatial judgements caused by line orientation or contextual depth cues. Prominent examples include the **Müller-Lyer Illusion** (where identical line segments appear unequal due to inward- or outward-pointing arrowheads) and the **Ponzo Illusion** (where converging linear perspective lines cause the upper horizontal line to appear longer than the lower one). **Ambiguous and Reversible Illusions:** Displays that create figure-ground confusion, forcing the brain to alternate between two valid perceptual interpretations, such as **Rubin's Vase** (alternating between a vase and two facing profiles). **Motion Illusions:** Apparent motion phenomena where non-moving images generate the perception of movement, such as the **Phi Phenomenon** or stroboscopic motion observed in animated displays.

Students can also write other illusions and constancy according to what they have taught

[15×2 = 30]